

STARFISH

Starfish are star-shaped, but they are not fish—they are echinoderms. This means that they have spiny skin. They cannot swim, but they are very good at crawling! They can walk up strands of seaweed and climb down the sides of rocks. Even in the deepest, darkest parts of the sea, there are starfish creeping around.

Starfish don't have any eyes. Instead, they have eyespots on the tips of their arms. These special cells cannot see shapes, but they can tell whether it is light or dark.

These bumps are actually spines.

Starfish's arms are very bendy because their skeleton is made up of lots of tiny spines that can move in any direction.

This crimson-knobbed starfish, like most starfish, measures less than eight inches (20 cm) from tip to tip. But some species are as wide as a small car!

Central disk

Starfish breathe through their feet and also through tiny tubes that are found all over their body.

Burrowing starfish

Cushion star

Common starfish

Stomach this

Starfish eat clams and mussels. When it finds one, it pulls open the shell with its tiny tube feet, pushes its whole stomach inside and slowly digests the animal's soft body.

